

COMA BERENICES

BERENICE'S HAIR

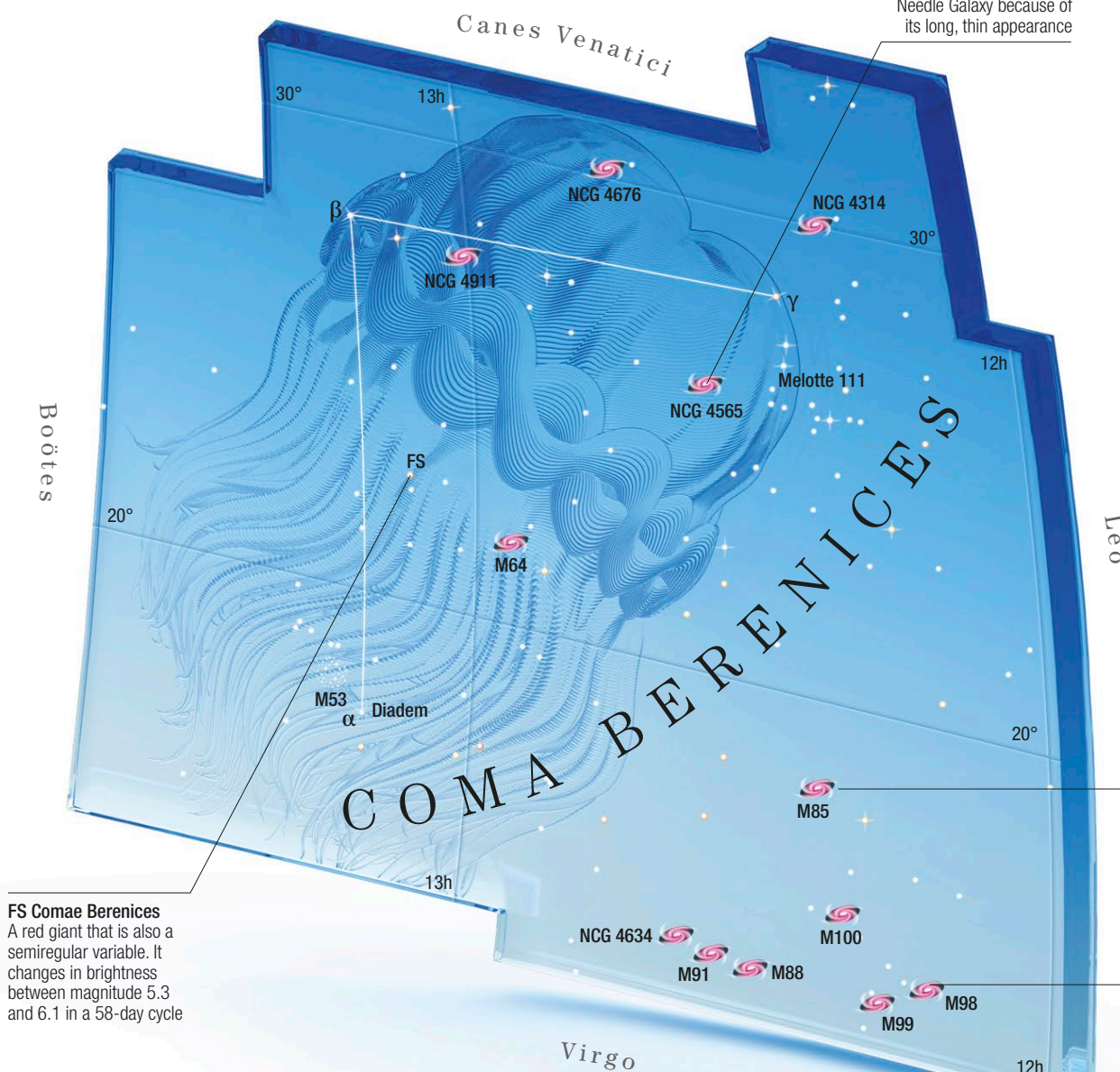
NAMED AFTER THE ANCIENT EGYPTIAN QUEEN BERENICES II, COMA BERENICES IS EASILY LOCATED BETWEEN THE MORE PROMINENT CONSTELLATIONS OF LEO AND BOÖTES. IT CONTAINS CLUSTERS OF BOTH STARS AND GALAXIES.

Considered part of Leo until 1536, Coma Berenices was first shown as a separate constellation on a globe by German cartographer Caspar Vopel. The constellation has no stars brighter than 4th magnitude, but plenty of interesting deep-sky objects. Galaxies such as M85, M88, M99, and M100 near the southern border with Virgo are part of the Virgo Cluster about 50 million light-years away. Others belong to the Coma Cluster, which is six times more distant. Melotte 111 is one of the closest open star clusters: more than 20 of its stars are visible to the naked eye.



△ M64
The brightest galaxy in Coma Berenices, M64 is nicknamed the Black Eye Galaxy because of the lane of dark dust near its bright core. It lies 17 million light-years from Earth.

NGC 4565
A spiral galaxy seen edge on. Commonly called the Needle Galaxy because of its long, thin appearance



FS Comae Berenices
A red giant that is also a semiregular variable. It changes in brightness between magnitude 5.3 and 6.1 in a 58-day cycle

KEY DATA

Size ranking	42
Brightest stars	Beta (β) 4.2, Diadem (α) 4.3
Genitive	Comae Berenices
Abbreviation	Com
Highest in sky at 10pm	April–May
Fully visible	90°N–56°S



CHART 5

MAIN STARS

Diadem Alpha (α) Comae Berenices	Binary star consisting of two main-sequence stars
☆ 4.3	↔ 58 light-years
Beta (β) Comae Berenices	Yellow main-sequence star
☆ 4.2	↔ 30 light-years
Gamma (γ) Comae Berenices	Orange giant
☆ 4.3	↔ 167 light-years
FS Comae Berenices	Red giant and semiregular variable star
☆ 5.6	↔ 736 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

Melotte 111 (Coma Star Cluster)	Open cluster
M53 (NGC 5024)	Globular cluster
M64 (Black Eye Galaxy, NGC 4826)	Spiral galaxy
M85 (NGC 4382)	Lenticular galaxy
M88 (NGC 4501)	Spiral galaxy
M91 (NGC 4548)	Barred spiral galaxy
M99 (NGC 4254)	Spiral galaxy
M100 (NGC 4321)	Spiral galaxy
NGC 4565 (Needle Galaxy)	Spiral galaxy

M85
A lenticular galaxy about 125,000 light-years wide and 60 million light-years from Earth

M98
A spiral galaxy seen nearly edge-on, 44 million light-years away. Part of the Virgo Cluster and discovered in 1791 on the same day as M99 and M100